

Target Companies — Des Moines Cybersecurity & MSP

Robert Swanger | Job Fair Research | August 2026

Tier 1 — Job Fair Targets (September 30)

Talk to these first. Both are MSPs with explicit cybersecurity focus and are directly in line with your career goals.

Koltiv (formerly Associated Computer Systems)

Location: Urbandale, IA (HQ) — local to DMACC

Website: koltiv.com

Type: MSP — Managed IT + Cybersecurity

Size: 51–200 employees

Founded: 1980 (rebranded as Koltiv July 2025)

Recognition: CRN MSP 500 Elite 150 (2026), Tech Elite 250 — every year since 2018

Security Stack: Arctic Wolf (MDR/SOC-as-a-service), Cisco, VMware, Dell, Palo Alto, Pure Storage

Services: Managed IT (SHIELD/ARMOR/FORTRESS tiers), cybersecurity, vCISO, penetration testing, compliance

Clients: SMB/SME — 20 to 150 users, manufacturing, healthcare, financial services

Google Rating: 5/5 across 13 reviews

Entry Pay (ACS era): ~\$46,905 Client Services Specialist — comparable to IP Pathways entry range

Why It Fits: Arctic Wolf partnership = closest thing to SOC-adjacent work at an MSP in Des Moines. Security-first culture, smaller size means more intern exposure. Directly aligned with blue team/SOC career path.

Intel: Rebranded only 13 months ago — still building identity. Good time to get in early.

IP Pathways

Location: Urbandale, IA (HQ) / Columbus, OH (acquired SSI 2023)

Website: ippathways.com

Type: MSP + VAR — Managed Services, Cloud, Data Center, Professional Services

Recognition: CRN 250 Most Certified, 500 Largest, 150 Fastest Growing IT providers in North America

Tech Stack: VMware, Cisco, Cisco Meraki, NetApp, Sophos, Veeam, Aruba

Proprietary Platforms: AdaptiveCloud, Tenax IQ (compliance/vulnerability management)

Clients: Businesses, local/state government, healthcare across Midwest — 400+ customers

Entry Pay: \$44K–\$57K (employer posted for Support/Deployment Technician)

Mid-Level Pay: \$71K–\$108K Support Engineer

Glassdoor: 4.0/5 — 46 reviews. Compensation rated 3.9/5.

Employee Note: Current Columbus deployment tech (Sep 2025): "A great starting point in tech to pivot from."

Why It Fits: VMware overlap with your lab. Larger company with more structured path. Explicitly invests in cert training for employees. Midwest HQ means local presence matters.

Intel: Columbus office is a recent acquisition (SSI merger 2023) still being integrated — the Urbandale HQ is the real operation. You're local to HQ which matters.

Tier 2 — Cold Outreach Targets (Post Job Fair)

Not at the job fair but worth direct outreach after September 30. LinkedIn message to owner or hiring manager — short, direct, reference DMACC Cybersecurity program and homelab.

TeamLogic IT of Des Moines

Location: Ankeny, IA — your backyard

Website: teamlogicit.com

Type: MSP — Managed IT, Cybersecurity, Cloud

Recognition: Two-time MSP of the Year (national network). 5/5 across 36 Google reviews — highest review depth of any 5.0-rated Des Moines MSP.

Why It Fits: Ankeny location is ideal. Cybersecurity focus. 24/7 coverage model means real monitoring work, not just ticket-taking. Locally owned so decisions move fast.

CMIT Solutions of Des Moines

Location: Clive, IA

Website: cmitsolutions.com/des-moines

Type: MSP — Managed IT + Cybersecurity for SMBs

Notable: Veteran-led, locally owned, backed by national network of 250+ CMIT offices

Why It Fits: Veteran-led business — direct cultural fit angle given your Army background. Security-first approach. Serves insurance, healthcare, construction clients in metro.

LDTech

Location: West Des Moines, IA

Type: MSP — Security-first managed IT, cloud, network management

Founded: 2006

Clients: Medical, legal, manufacturing, K-8 education

Google Rating: 5/5

Why It Fits: Security-first model matches your goals. Smaller firm means more hands-on exposure as an intern or entry hire.

American Technology Consulting

Location: Des Moines, IA

Type: IT Consulting — cybersecurity and SOC-adjacent roles

Notable: Appears repeatedly in Des Moines cybersecurity job listings for security analyst and SOC support roles. Contracts with state agencies.

Why It Fits: SOC-adjacent work including triage, incident support, and data collection for state agencies. Closer to the actual SOC analyst role than a pure MSP help desk.

Baker Group

Location: Des Moines, IA

Website: bakergroupiowa.com

Type: Engineering and Technology firm — internal IT/cybersecurity function

Notable: Has posted Senior Security Analyst roles internally. Not an MSP — internal security team for a large engineering firm.

Why It Fits: Internal security team experience is different from MSP — you'd be working on one organization's security posture deeply rather than across many clients. Good for blue team depth.

Outreach Strategy Notes

- Job fair order: Koltiv → IP Pathways → Nationwide → MidAmerican Energy → Casey's

- For cold outreach to Tier 2: LinkedIn message to owner or IT manager. Keep it under 5 sentences. Reference DMACC Cybersecurity AAS, homelab with pfSense/Suricata/Wazuh, and that you're looking for spring/summer internship.
- Meraki CMNA cert (free) — complete before September 30 if possible. Directly relevant to IP Pathways and Koltiv stacks.
- Sophos cert (free) — directly relevant to IP Pathways stack.
- Ask at every booth: "What does the path from internship to full-time typically look like here?"
- GitHub/Obsidian vault published before job fair — gives them something to look at after the conversation.